

Zerava — Branding & Logo Design Document

0. Purpose of This Document

This document defines Zerava's **visual identity system** before any logo is designed. Its job is to eliminate ambiguity, taste-based arguments, and random aesthetics.

The logo and brand must communicate **clarity, restraint, and technical trust**. If a design choice does not reinforce those ideas, it is wrong.

This document is binding. Design comes after agreement.

1. Brand Essence

Brand Name: Zerava

Tagline: Zero noise. Real security.

What Zerava Is: A calm, high-signal cybersecurity product for founders and small teams who need answers, not panic.

What Zerava Is Not: - Not hacker cosplay - Not fear-driven security marketing - Not enterprise bloat disguised as "power"

Zerava behaves like a senior engineer who explains problems clearly and leaves you knowing exactly what to do next.

2. Brand Personality

Zerava's personality guides every visual decision.

Traits: - Quietly confident - Analytical - Minimal but intentional - Professional without stiffness

Tone Visually: - No visual shouting - No gimmicks - No aggressive symbolism

If it looks like it's trying too hard, it does not belong.

3. Logo Design Philosophy

3.1 Core Requirements (Non-Negotiable)

The logo must: - Scale cleanly from favicon to billboard - Be legible in monochrome - Work on dark and light backgrounds - Remain recognizable at small sizes

The logo must **not**: - Rely solely on typography - Use shields, locks, skulls, bugs, hoodies, or binary rain - Feel chaotic, sketchy, or noisy

3.2 Symbol-First Identity Rule

Zerava's identity is **symbol-led**, with typography as support.

The symbol must: - Communicate inspection, filtering, or clarity - Feel abstract and modern - Avoid literal security clichés

Typography must never be the identity by itself.

4. Approved Logo Concept Directions

Design exploration must stay within these lanes.

Option A: Aperture / Lens Symbol

Meaning: - Scanning - Focus - Precision

Why it fits: - Directly aligns with Zerava's scanning role - Neutral and technical - Strong at icon sizes

Option B: Signal Filter / Noise Reduction

Meaning: - Zero noise - Signal extraction - Clarity from chaos

Visual ideas: - Interrupted waveforms - Clean cuts through abstract lines - Reduction from many to few

Option C: Layered Surface Scan

Meaning: - Multi-layer analysis - Surface-level vulnerability detection

Visual ideas: - Parallel planes - Offset layers - Depth without complexity

5. Typography System

Primary Typeface Direction: - Sans-serif - Humanist or neo-grotesk - High readability

Traits required: - Neutral - Modern - Professional

Avoid: - Decorative fonts - Overly futuristic typefaces - Hacker-style monospace as branding font

Monospace may be used **inside reports only**, never as brand typography.

6. Color System

6.1 Core Palette Principles

- Restrained
- Low saturation
- High contrast

Primary palette direction: - Deep neutral base (charcoal / near-black) - One controlled accent (cool blue, cyan, or muted green)

6.2 Color Usage Rules

- Accent color is used sparingly
- Red is reserved strictly for critical findings inside reports
- Branding never uses alarm colors

Trust beats urgency.

7. Logo Usage Rules

7.1 Clear Space

The logo must always maintain breathing room equal to the height of the symbol.

7.2 Background Control

Approved: - Solid dark - Solid light - Subtle gradients

Not approved: - Busy images - Patterns - Textured backgrounds

8. Brand Feel Test (Final Check)

If someone sees Zerava's logo for 2 seconds, they should think:

"This looks serious, calm, and competent."

If the reaction is: - "This looks scary" - "This looks flashy" - "This looks like every other security tool"

Then the branding has failed.

9. Execution Lock

No logo design, no color experimentation, and no visual assets are produced until: - This document is agreed on - One concept direction is chosen

Brand clarity comes before aesthetics.

Zerava branding prioritizes **signal, restraint, and trust**. Everything else is noise.